AI readiness checklist

24 quick checks. Tick what's true today, then count your ticks.

Use this with your leadership team. Anything unticked is a good place to start — and exactly what an AI Dome readiness check looks at.

1. Strategy

- [ ] We know the top three jobs we want AI to help with.
- [ ] A leader is accountable for how we use AI.
- [ ] We know how we will measure success (time saved, service, quality).
- [ ] We have a budget and timeline for AI adoption.
- [ ] Staff have been told why we are adopting AI.

2. Governance

- [ ] We have a written AI acceptable use policy.
- [ ] We keep a list of approved AI tools.
- [ ] We keep an AI register of tools and agents in use.
- [ ] A person approves anything AI sends, pays, deletes or publishes.
- [ ] Our privacy policy covers AI-assisted decisions (required from 10 Dec 2026).

3. Security

- [ ] Multi-factor authentication is on for everyone.
- [ ] We know which AI tools staff already use (shadow AI).
- [ ] Sensitive data is blocked from public AI tools.
- [ ] Someone monitors our systems 24/7.
- [ ] We have a plan for an AI-related data leak or error.

4. People

- [ ] Everyone has had safe and secure AI training.
- [ ] Each team has someone confident to help others (an AI Champion).
- [ ] Leaders have had AI leadership training.
- [ ] We have talked openly about AI and jobs.
- [ ] Staff know where to get help with AI.

5. Data & systems

- [ ] We know what sensitive data we hold and where it lives.
- [ ] Our key systems (email, CRM, accounts) are up to date and backed up.
- [ ] Our documents and policies are organised so AI can use them.
- [ ] We know which systems an AI agent would need to connect to.

0–8 ticks
Getting started: build foundations first.

9–17 ticks
Building: ready for governed AI agents.

18–24 ticks
Ready to scale: focus on agents and adoption.